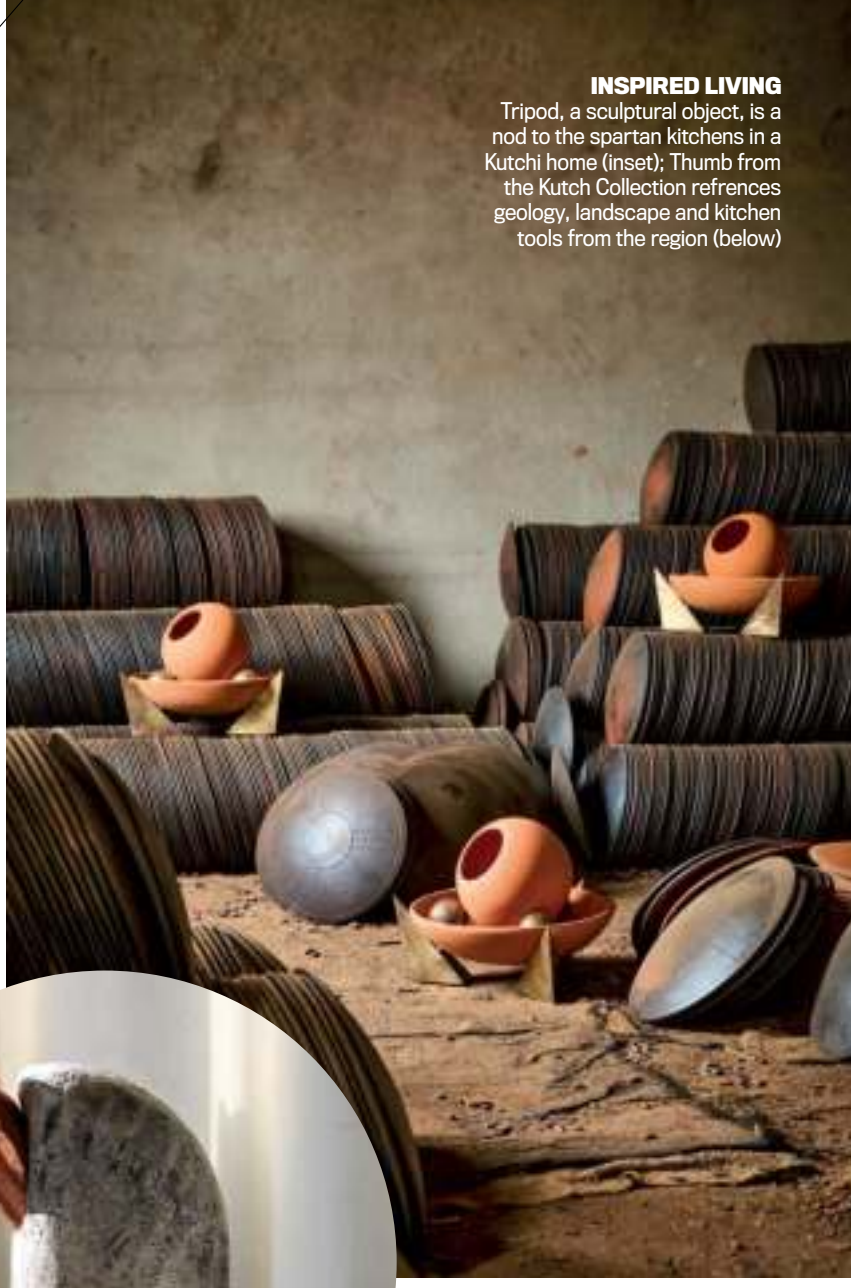


INSPIRED LIVING
Tripod, a sculptural object, is a nod to the spartan kitchens in a Kutchi home (inset); Thumb from the Kutch Collection refrences geology, landscape and kitchen tools from the region (below)

Creative Coupling

What happens when a stylist and his craft-loving client team up? Heritage and artisanal pieces find a new meaning and home

By **RIDHI KALE**



Interior stylist Samir Wadekar's career feels less like a straight line and more like a brilliantly improvised dance of serendipity. What started as a 'why not?' internship at a top interiors magazine soon blossomed into a full-time styling gig—and then into something even bigger. When client Gunjan Gupta challenged him to outfit her Gandhidham home using only Indian antiques and homegrown brands, the two discovered a mutual passion for regional crafts—and Amrai was born.

"Amrai—literally 'mango orchard'—captures our vision of a flourishing ecosystem where creativity, tradition and community bear fruit together," explains Wadekar. An orchard isn't just a collection of trees; it's a living network that offers shade, sustenance and endless inspiration. In the same spirit, Amrai brings artisans, designers and art lovers under one canopy, each one adding a unique flavour to the collective harvest.

Years after that first home makeover, Gupta returned with a fresh brief: "Design a collection for me." Wadekar turned to her home turf—Kutch—for inspiration. Its vibrant hues, storied landscapes and masterful crafts became the blueprint for Amrai's debut series: six sculptural statement pieces that echo Kutch's terrain and tales.

Alongside these sculptural artworks, Amrai curates vintage textiles, garments and silver jewellery—each item unearthed from the heart of Kutch's bazaars. "We share an unabashed love for India's craft heritage and the countless narratives woven into every piece," says Wadekar. This capsule collection is both homage and handshake to Kutch's rich artistry.

Pottery pieces start at ₹13,000 and go up to ₹20,000; vintage treasures are priced on request, reflecting their one-of-a-kind nature. **AT** www.amraiindia.com